

Global Renewable Energy in 2025

How Far Have We Come?

Source: Our World in Data · Ember (2026) · Energy Institute Statistical Review (2025)



75% of Global GHG Emissions Still Come from Fossil Fuels

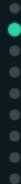
Since the Industrial Revolution, global energy systems have become dominated by fossil fuels. Burning them drives climate change and causes at least 5 million premature deaths annually from air pollution.

75%

of global GHG emissions from fossil fuels

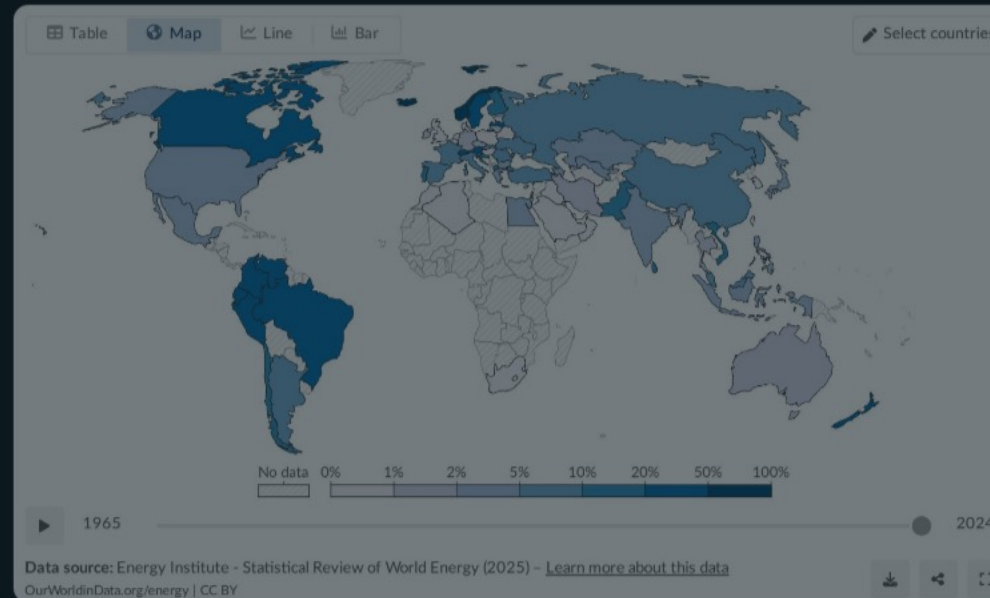
5M+

premature deaths per year from air pollution



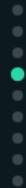
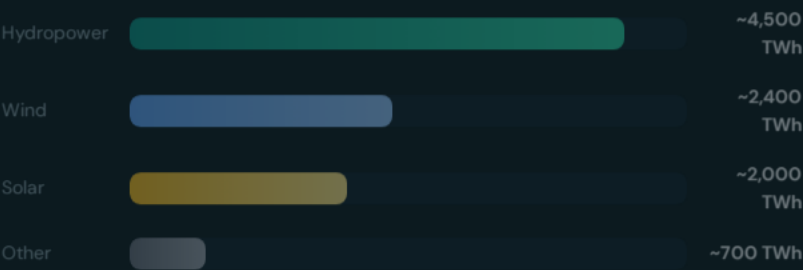
Renewables Now Supply ~14% of Global Primary Energy

Approximately one-seventh of the world's primary energy comes from renewable technologies (2024, substitution method). Primary energy includes electricity, transport, and heating combined.

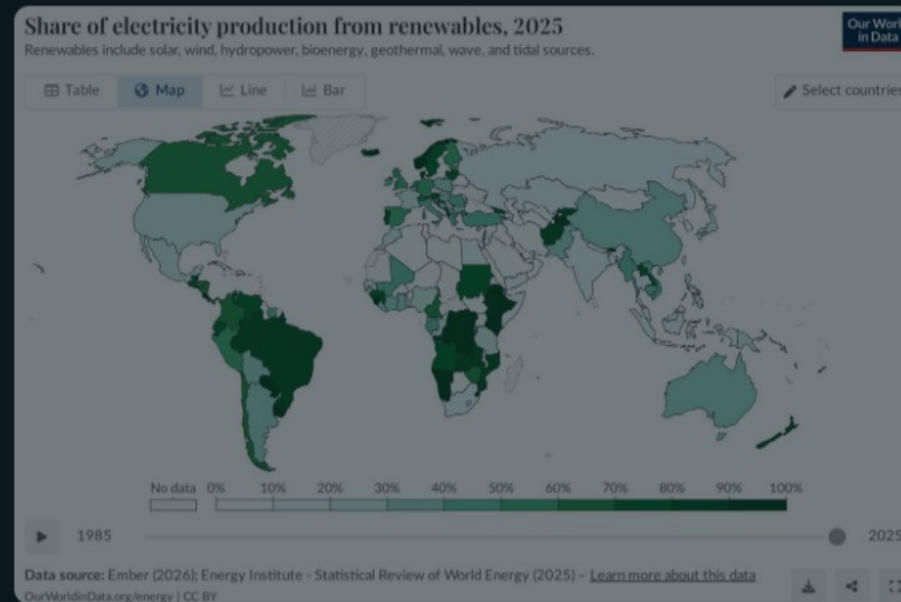


Renewable Electricity Generation Is Growing Rapidly

Breakdown by technology (2024 data):

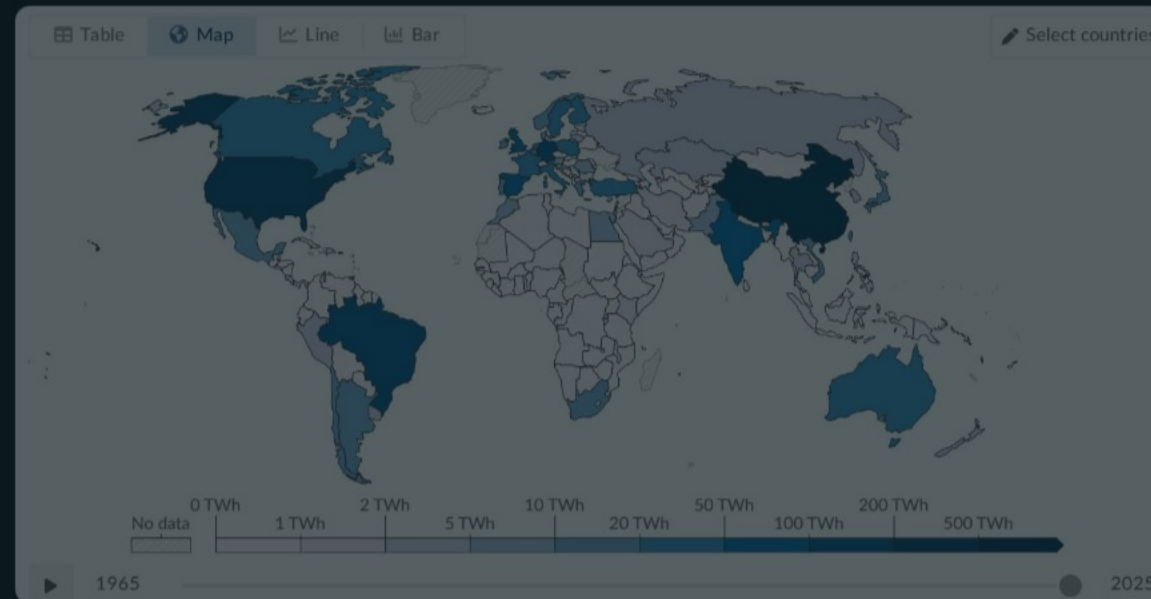


Almost **One-Third** of Global Electricity Now Comes from Renewables

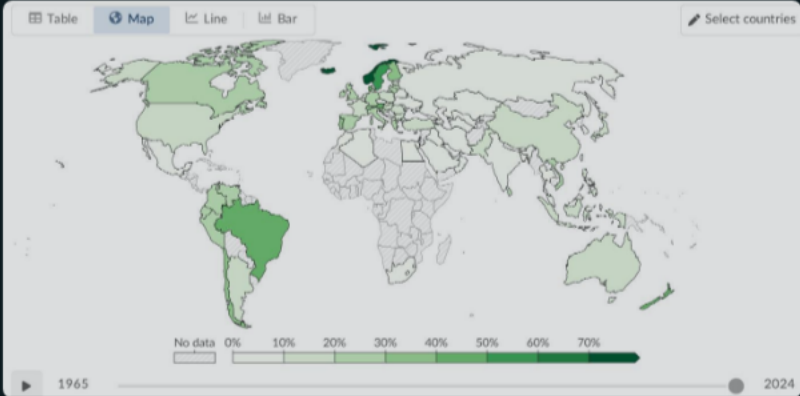


Hydropower Remains the Largest Renewable Source at ~50%

Hydropower accounts for roughly half of all renewable electricity generation. Top producers: China, Brazil, and Canada. It has been generating electricity at scale for over a century.



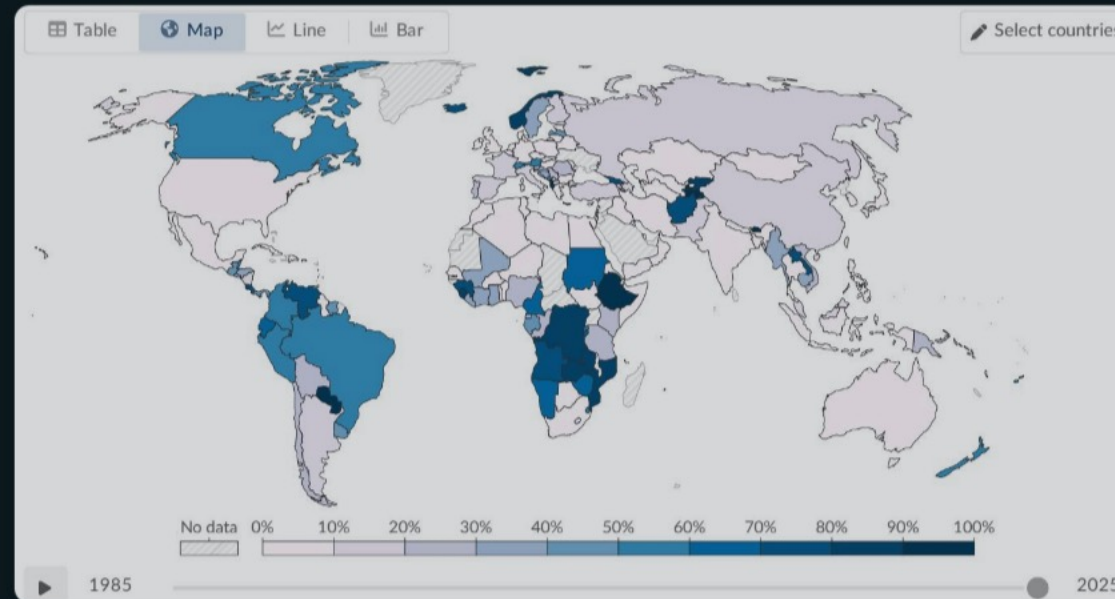
Wind and Solar Are the **Fastest-Growing** Energy Technologies in History



Technology	Generation	Share
Wind	~2,400 TWh	~25%
Solar	~2,000 TWh	~21%

Solar is the fastest-growing source with dramatic growth since 2010, driven by falling costs and policy support. Wind and solar combined now nearly match hydropower's output.

Stark Regional Gaps: Sub-Saharan Africa Lags While Scandinavia and Latin America Lead



60–98%

Scandinavia & Latin America renewable electricity share

<10%

Sub-Saharan Africa & Middle East renewable share

Key Takeaways: Renewables Are Growing Fast but the Transition Must Accelerate

14% → 30%

Renewables now supply ~14% of primary energy and ~30% of electricity — significant but insufficient for climate targets.

Hydro Dominant

Hydropower generates ~50% of renewable electricity, but growth potential is limited vs. wind and solar.

Wind + Solar Rising

Fastest-growing technologies in history. Combined, they now produce nearly as much as hydropower.

The pace of transition must accelerate to meet global climate goals.

